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THE WHITE HOUSE

WASHINGTON

March 24, 1993

MEMORANDUM FOR THE SECRETARY OF STATE
THE SECRETARY OF DEFENSE
DIRECTOR OF CENTRAL INTELLIGENCE
THE CHAIRMAN, JOINT CHIEFS OF STAFF
REPRESENTATIVE OF THE UNITED STATES TO THE
UNITED NATIONS
ASSISTANT TO THE VICE PRESIDENT FOR
NATIONAL SECURITY AFFAIRS

SUBJECT: Decisions of Principals Committee Meeting on
Bosnia, March 13, 1993 ~~(S)~~

Committee members agreed on the need to develop a concept of
phased implementation/enforcement of a Bosnian settlement that:

- avoids a self-defeating delay during which an agreement
could fall apart precisely because of failure to enforce it;
- while also building in fail safe provisions to prevent the
involvement of U.S. ground forces in a situation in which a
settlement was being ignored and fighting continued
virtually unabated. ~~(S)~~

During an initial period after signature of an agreement by all
three parties and before this condition could be judged to have
been met, air power might be used against any party engaged in a
major violation. ~~(S)~~

Elements of a possible U.S. ground contribution could be getting
into place, e.g. in Split, during this interim period. ~~(S)~~

The Committee will meet again to refine this concept. It will
address questions such as whether we would threaten punitive
action against targets in Serbia, or tactical action, e.g.
against Bosnian Serb artillery shelling Sarajevo; how to frame
the message we would send at time of signature; and when and how
to inject this concept into multilateral planning. ~~(S)~~

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PER E.O. 13526



Anthony Lake
Assistant to the President
for National Security Affairs

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Declassify on: OADR

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Clinton Presidential Records Mandatory Declassification Review

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Documents from this Mandatory Declassification Review were released in full or released in part.

Those documents released with redactions have been restricted under Section 1.4 (c) of E.O. 13526 and (b)(3) of the FOIA.
